

## UNIT 1 · TOPIC 1.6

# Passenger Name Record (PNR)

*Six characters that hold an entire journey.*

B.B.A. Aviation Management · Semester III · Unit 1: Overview of the Airline Industry  
Air Ticketing & Fare Construction (2ACBAM32) · Arun Kumar

**BOARDING PASS**

LEARNER

**STU**

PROFESSIONAL

**PRO**

FLIGHT

**ATF 1.6**

GATE

**PERIOD 6**

DURATION

**00:40**

SEAT

**SEM III**

CLASS

**HANDS-ON**

BOARDING

**NOW**

## TOPIC 1.6

# In-Flight Movie: Topic Intro

UNIT 1 · TOPIC 1.6

OVERVIEW OF THE AIRLINE INDUSTRY

## Passenger Name Record (PNR)

*Six characters that hold an entire journey.*

AIR TICKETING & FARE CONSTRUCTION · UNIT 1 · TOPIC 1.6

✈ BOARDING PASS

**STU** ✈ **PRO**

|                          |                        |
|--------------------------|------------------------|
| FLIGHT<br><b>ATF 1.6</b> | GATE<br><b>P6</b>      |
| DURATION<br><b>00:40</b> | BOARDING<br><b>NOW</b> |

Barcode

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02

## TOPIC 1.6

## Pre-Flight Question



THINK ABOUT IT

Six letters and numbers can hold your entire trip. What do you think they contain?

**THINK**

30 seconds alone

**PAIR**

1 minute with a neighbour

**SHARE**

2-3 answers with the class



## TOPIC 1.6

# Today's Flight Plan

1

**1.6.1**

What is a PNR: its purpose and importance in the travel process

2

**1.6.2**

PNR structure: key fields — name, flight details, special requests

3

**1.6.3**

PNR data entry and retrieval: creating, modifying and updating PNRs

4

**1.6.4**

PNR retention policies: how long data is kept and why

**BY LANDING, YOU WILL**

- Define a PNR and its record locator
- List the mandatory and optional PNR elements
- Create, retrieve and modify a PNR (simulation)
- Explain PNR retention and data-privacy rules

*Pedagogy: Kinesthetic Learning*



## TOPIC 1.6.1

## What Is a PNR?

*The Passenger Name Record is the master file of a booking.*

**Record locator**

A unique 6-character alphanumeric code, e.g., “K7QX2M”, used to find the booking.

**Single source of truth**

Airline, agent, airport and passenger all rely on the same record.

**Full history**

Every change is logged with who made it and when.

**DEFINITION**

A PNR is an electronic record in a reservation system that contains the itinerary and personal details of a passenger or group travelling together.



**TOPIC 1.6.1**

# Why the PNR Matters

*Every stage of the journey reads from the PNR.*



## **Ticketing**

Ticket numbers are linked to the PNR for issue, change and refund.



## **Airport**

Check-in, seats, meals and wheelchair needs come from the PNR.



## **Security & Border**

Governments receive PNR/API data for security screening.



## **Service**

Call centres retrieve it to handle changes and complaints.



## TOPIC 1.6.2

## PNR Structure: The Mandatory Elements

*Memory aid: P-R-I-N-T — a PNR cannot be saved without these.*

| Letter   | Element               | What it holds                        | Amadeus example                |
|----------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>P</b> | Phone / contact       | Agency and passenger contact details | AP DEL 9876543210              |
| <b>R</b> | Received from         | Who requested the booking            | RF RAHUL                       |
| <b>I</b> | Itinerary             | Flight segments sold                 | SS1Y1 (sell 1 seat, Y, line 1) |
| <b>N</b> | Name                  | Surname / first name and title       | NM1SHARMA/RAHUL MR             |
| <b>T</b> | Ticketing arrangement | Time limit or ticketed status        | TKOK or TKTL20NOV              |

## TOPIC 1.6.2

## Optional & Special Request Fields



### SSR - Special Service

Needs requiring action: WCHR (wheelchair), VGML (vegetarian meal), UMNR (unaccompanied minor).



### OSI - Other Info

Information only, no action: e.g., VIP, frequent traveller notes.



### APIS / DOCS

Passport details required for international travel.



### Remarks & FF

Agency remarks, frequent-flyer number, seat requests.

## TOPIC 1.6.3

## Creating a PNR: Step by Step

*A simplified Amadeus-style session.*

- Search availability for the route and date.
- Sell the seat in the chosen class.
- Add name, contact, ticketing and received-from.
- End transaction to save and get the record locator.

```
AMADEUS-STYLE (simplified)

> AN20NOVDLBO
> SS1Y1
> NM1SHARMA/RAHUL MR
> AP DEL 9876543210
> TKTL18NOV
> RF RAHUL
> ER

// Record locator: K7QX2M
```

## TOPIC 1.6.3

## Retrieve, Modify, Update

*Most agent work is on existing PNRs, not new ones.*



### Retrieve

By record locator (RT K7QX2M)  
or by name and flight.  
Passengers use surname +  
locator online.



### Modify

Change dates, add SSRs,  
correct contact details. Name  
changes are usually restricted.



### Cancel Elements

Cancel a segment or field (XE  
command) and re-save; history  
logs the change.

**TOPIC 1.6.4**

## PNR Retention & Privacy

*PNRs contain personal data — how long can they be kept?*

### Days

GDS/airline active PNRs are typically purged soon after travel is completed

### 5 yrs

EU PNR Directive: data kept for security use, masked after 6 months

### 5 yrs

India's PNR regulations (2022) require airlines to share and retain data for 5 years



Purpose: fighting terrorism and serious crime, while data-protection laws (GDPR, India's DPDP Act 2023) limit misuse.

## TOPIC 1.6.4

## Why Retention Policies Exist

**Security**

Authorities analyse travel patterns to identify risks.

**Legal & disputes**

Records support refunds, audits and chargeback disputes.

**Privacy**

Data must be protected, masked and deleted on schedule.

**AGENT'S DUTY**

Never share PNR details over unverified phone calls or social media. Ask for the locator AND the surname, and follow your agency's data-protection policy.



**TOPIC 1.6**

## Cabin Crew Activity: Build a Paper PNR

**PEDAGOGY****Kinesthetic Learning****TIME · 12 min****FORMAT · Pairs · role-play**

- 1 One student is the passenger, the other the reservation agent.
- 2 Agent fills a printed PNR template using the PRINT elements.
- 3 Add one SSR (meal or wheelchair) and one OSI.
- 4 Swap roles: modify the date and cancel one element — log the change.

**TOPIC 1.6***Click to reveal each answer*

## Pre-Landing Check

**Q1**

**A PNR record locator usually has how many characters?**

- A) 4
- B) 6
- C) 10
- D) 13

**ANSWER****B****Q2**

**In the PRINT memory aid, “R” stands for...**

- A) Refund
- B) Route
- C) Received from
- D) Remarks

**ANSWER****C****Q3**

**A wheelchair request is entered as an...**

- A) OSI
- B) SSR
- C) RF
- D) TK

**ANSWER****B****Q4**

**How long does India’s 2022 PNR regulation require data to be retained?**

- A) 6 months
- B) 1 year
- C) 5 years
- D) 10 years

**ANSWER****C**

**SAFE LANDING**

# Key Takeaways

- ✓ The PNR is the master booking record, found by a 6-character locator
- ✓ Mandatory elements: Phone, Received, Itinerary, Name, Ticketing (PRINT)
- ✓ SSR needs action; OSI is information only
- ✓ PNR data is retained for security but protected by privacy law

**EXIT TICKET** Write 1 thing you learned today + 1 question you still have.

**NEXT DEPARTURE****Topic 1.7 — E-ticketing and IATA Standards**

**Thank you · Questions?**